

# Jonah and the Big Fish

ገጽ ፩ ስም ፩

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories - Book 7

ገጽ ፩ ስም ፩ ገጽ ፩ ስም ፩ - ገጽ ፩ 7

*For all the children who learn that God's plans are always best.*

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## Page 1

*[PICTURE: A kind-looking man named Jonah standing in an ancient village, wearing simple robes. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

A long time ago, there was a man named Jonah. He loved God very much. God had a special job for Jonah to do.

### TIGRINYA:

ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና  
ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና ገና

(Pronunciation: ገና = Yonas = Jonah, ገና ገና = Amlak = God, ገና ገና = fluuy = special)

## Page 2

*[PICTURE: God's voice coming from the sky as bright golden light shining down on Jonah who looks up. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

God said to Jonah, "Go to the big city of Nineveh. Tell the people there to stop doing bad things." It was an important message.

### TIGRINYA:

ገግግግ ገግግግ "ገገ ገገግ ገገግ ገገግ ገገግ ገገግ ገገግ ገገግ ገገግግ ገገግግ" ገገግ  
ገገግግ ገገግግግ ገገግግ

(Pronunciation: ገገግ = ketema = city, ገገግ = Nenewe = Nineveh, ገገግግግ = mel'ikhti = message)

## Page 3

*[PICTURE: Jonah looking scared and worried, shaking his head, turning away from the direction of Nineveh. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

But Jonah was afraid! He did not want to go to Nineveh. The people there were mean and scary. Jonah decided to run away from God.

### TIGRINYA:

ገገ ገገገ ገገገ! ገገ ገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ ገገገ ገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ  
ገገገ ገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ

(Pronunciation: ገገገ = ferihu = afraid, ገገገገ = kihadm = to run away, ገገገ = wesene = decided)

## Page 4

*[PICTURE: Jonah running toward a harbor with wooden ships and blue sea in background. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Jonah ran to the seaport. He found a big ship going far away to a place called Tarshish. He paid money and got on the ship.

### TIGRINYA:

ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን  
ጋሎን ጋሎን ጋሎን

(Pronunciation: ጋሎን = wedeb = port, ጋሎን = merkeb = ship, ጋሎን = genzeb = money)

[PICTURE: Jonah sleeping peacefully below deck of the wooden ship while it sails on calm blue waters. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The ship sailed away on the blue sea. Jonah went down below the deck. He fell fast asleep. He thought he could hide from God.

[illegible]

(Pronunciation:  $\text{bahri}$  = sea,  $\text{degese}$  = slept,  $\text{kihibae}$  = to hide)

## Page 6

*[PICTURE: Dark storm clouds gathering over the sea, huge waves beginning to form, the ship rocking violently. East African/Eritrean features on sailors. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

But God sent a mighty storm! The wind blew hard. The waves grew tall and crashed against the ship. The boat rocked back and forth.

### TIGRINYA:

ጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ! ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ  
ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋጸጋጸጋ

(Pronunciation: ጸጋጸጋ = *ma'ibel* = storm, ጸጋጸጋ = *nifas* = wind, ጸጋጸጋ = *bihayli* = strongly)



## Page 7

*[PICTURE: Terrified sailors on deck praying to different gods, throwing cargo overboard into raging seas. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

The sailors were very scared! They prayed to their gods but nothing helped. They threw heavy boxes into the sea to make the ship lighter.

### TIGRINYA:

ጸሎት ጸሎትጸሎት ጸሎት ጸሎት! ጸሎት ጸሎትጸሎት ጸሎት ጸሎት ጸሎትጸሎት ጸሎት ጸሎት  
ጸሎትጸሎት ጸሎት ጸሎት ጸሎት ጸሎት

(Pronunciation: ጸሎትጸሎት = merkebenyatat = sailors, ጸሎት = ferihom = scared, ጸሎት = tseleyu = prayed)

## Page 8

*[PICTURE: The ship captain finding Jonah sleeping below deck during the terrible storm, looking surprised and angry. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

The captain found Jonah still sleeping! "How can you sleep?" he shouted.  
"Wake up and pray to your God! Maybe He will save us!"

### TIGRINYA:

ጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋጸጋ ጸጋ ጸጋጋ ጸጋጋ! "ጸጋጋ ጸጋጋ ጸጋጋጋ?" ጸጋጋጋ "ጸጋጋጋ ጸጋ ጸጋጋጋጋ ጸጋጋ!  
ጸጋጋጋጋ ጸጋጋጋጋ ጸጋጋጋጋ!"

(Pronunciation: ጸጋጋጋ = tens'i = wake up, ጸጋ = tseli = pray, ጸጋጋጋጋ = kedHnena = save us)

## Page 9

*[PICTURE: Sailors gathered around Jonah on the stormy deck, pointing at him, Jonah looking guilty and ashamed. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

The sailors asked, "Who caused this storm?" They found out it was because of Jonah. Jonah told them he was running away from God.

### TIGRINYA:

ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳጳጳጳ "ጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳ?" ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ  
ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳጳ

(Pronunciation: ጳጳጳ = *ma'ibel* = storm, ጳጳጳ = *felet'u* = found out, ጳጳጳ = *yihadm* = running away)

## Page 10

*[PICTURE: Jonah standing at the edge of the ship with arms outstretched, telling the sailors to throw him into the stormy sea. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Jonah said, "Throw me into the sea and the storm will stop." The sailors did not want to, but the storm got worse and worse.

### TIGRINYA:

ጵጵ "ጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵ" ጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵ  
ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ

(Pronunciation: ጵጵጵጵ = derbiyuni = throw me, ጵጵጵጵ = ki'arif = will stop, ጵጵጵጵጵ = inageded = getting worse)

## Page 11

*[PICTURE: Jonah being thrown into the dark churning sea by the sailors, splash of water, dramatic stormy sky. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Finally, the sailors picked up Jonah and threw him into the sea. Splash! Right away, the storm stopped. The sea became calm and peaceful.

### TIGRINYA:

፳፻ ሰፋፋፋ ሰፋፋ ሰፋፋፋፋፋ ሰፋፋ ሰፋፋፋ ፳፻ ሰፋፋ ሰፋፋፋፋ ፳፻! ፳፻ ሰፋፋ ፳፻ ሰፋፋፋ ሰፋፋ ሰፋፋፋ ሰፋፋፋ ፳፻፻ ፳፻፻

(Pronunciation: ፳፻፻፻ = derbeyuwo = threw him, ፳፻፻ = 'arefe = stopped, ፳፻፻ = hidu'e = calm)

## Page 12

*[PICTURE: A huge beautiful fish with an open mouth swimming toward Jonah who is sinking in the deep blue sea. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

But God did not let Jonah drown! He sent a very big fish to swallow Jonah whole. The big fish opened its mouth wide and - GULP!

### TIGRINYA:

ጸጋ ልጅጅ ልጅጅ ልጅጅ ልጅጅጅጅ! ልጅጅ ልጅጅ ልጅጅ ልጅ ልጅ ልጅጅ ልጅ ልጅ  
ልጅ ልጅ ልጅ ልጅ - ልጅጅ!

(Pronunciation: ልጅ = 'asa = fish, ልጅጅጅ = kiwiht'o = to swallow him, ልጅ = 'abi = big)

## Page 13

*[PICTURE: Jonah sitting inside the dark belly of the big fish, looking amazed and scared, with dim light filtering in. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Jonah was inside the big fish! It was dark and wet and very smelly. Jonah stayed inside the belly of the fish for three whole days and three nights.

### TIGRINYA:

ገገግ ሕገ ገገግ ሕገ ሕገ ገገግ! ገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ሕገ ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ  
ገገገ ገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ ሕገ ገገገ ሕገ ገገገገ

(Pronunciation: ገገገ = *wishtI* = inside, ገገገ = *kebdi* = belly, ገገገገ = *seleste* = three)

## Page 14

*[PICTURE: Jonah on his knees praying inside the fish's belly, hands clasped together, a soft glow around him. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Inside the fish, Jonah prayed to God. "I am sorry I ran away," he said. "Thank you for saving me. I will obey you now." God heard his prayer.

### TIGRINYA:

ጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ "ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ" ጵጵ "ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵጵ  
ጵጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ'ጵጵ" ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ

(Pronunciation: ጵጵጵ = tseleye = prayed, ጵጵጵጵ = yiqireta = sorry, ጵጵጵጵ = ki'izez = I will obey)



## Page 15

*[PICTURE: The big fish near a sandy beach, mouth wide open, spitting Jonah out onto dry land with a splash. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

After three days, God told the fish to spit Jonah out. The big fish swam to the shore and - BLEH! - out came Jonah onto dry land!

### TIGRINYA:

ገጽ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸ  
ጸጸጸ - ጸጸጸ! - ጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ!

*(Pronunciation: ጸጸጸ = kitif'o = to spit him out, ጸጸጸጸ = gemgem = shore, ጸጸጸ = meret = land)*

## Page 16

*[PICTURE: Jonah standing on the beach, looking grateful and relieved, the sun shining brightly on him, the big fish swimming away. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Jonah was so happy to be on dry land again! He thanked God for saving him. This time, he was ready to listen and obey God's instructions.

### TIGRINYA:

ገገግ ሆኖ ገገገ ሆኖ ሆኖ ገገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገገ! ሆኖ ገገገገ ገገገገገ ገገገገገ ሆኖ ሆኖ ሆኖ  
ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገ ገገገገገ ሆኖ ገገገገ

(Pronunciation: ገገገገ = *tehogose* = happy, ገገገገገ = *amesgene* = thanked, ሆኖ = *diluw* = ready)

## Page 17

*[PICTURE: God's voice coming from heaven again as golden light, Jonah looking up with a willing expression. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

God spoke to Jonah again. "Go to Nineveh and tell them my message." This time Jonah did not run away. He said, "Yes, God. I will go!"

### TIGRINYA:

ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገ "ገገ ገገገ ገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገገገ" ገገ ገገገ  
ገገገገገገገ "ገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ'ገ!" ገገገ

(Pronunciation: ገገገገ = tezarebo = spoke to him, ገገገገገገ = mel'ikhtey = my message, ገገ = iwe = yes)

## Page 18

*[PICTURE: Jonah walking on a dusty road toward the large walled city of Nineveh visible in the distance. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Jonah walked and walked until he reached the big city of Nineveh. It was a very large city with many people. Jonah took a deep breath and went inside.

### TIGRINYA:

ጵጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ  
ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ

(Pronunciation: ጵጵጵ = ketema = city, ጵጵጵጵ = zibets'iH = until reaching, ጵጵጵ = atewe = entered)

## Page 19

*[PICTURE: Jonah standing in the middle of a busy city square, arms raised, speaking boldly to crowds of people around him. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Jonah walked through the city shouting God's message. "Stop doing bad things!" he told everyone. "God wants you to change and be good!"

### TIGRINYA:

ጵጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵ "ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ!" ጵጵጵጵ  
ጵጵጵጵ "ጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ!"

(Pronunciation: ጵጵጵጵ = *absere* = proclaimed, ጵጵጵጵ = *aqwaritsu* = stop, ጵጵጵጵጵ = *kitqiyeru* = to change)

## Page 20

*[PICTURE: The king of Nineveh taking off his royal robes and putting on simple sackcloth, looking humble and sad. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Even the king of Nineveh heard Jonah's message! He took off his fancy robes and put on rough clothes. He told everyone to stop being bad and pray to God.

### TIGRINYA:

ጸጳስ ጸጳስ'ጸጳ ጸጳ ጸጳስ ጸጳጸጸጸ ጸጳስ! ጸጳጸጸ ጸጳስ ጸጳጸጸ ጸጳጸጸ ጸጳስ ጸጳጸጸ ጸጳጸጸ  
ጸጳስ ጸጳጸጸጸጸ ጸጳ ጸጳጸጸ ጸጳጸጸጸጸ ጸጳጸጸጸጸ

(Pronunciation: ጸጳስ = nigus = king, ጸጳስ = kidan = clothes, ጸጳስ = sem'e = heard)

## Page 21

*[PICTURE: All the people of Nineveh - men, women, children - kneeling and praying together, looking sorry for their sins. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

All the people of Nineveh listened! They were sorry for the bad things they had done. Men, women, and children all prayed to God and asked for forgiveness.

### TIGRINYA:

፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡! ፡፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡  
፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡

(Pronunciation: ፡፡፡፡፡፡ = tet'a'isom = repented, ፡፡፡፡፡፡ = yiqireta = forgiveness, ፡፡፡፡ = Hatetu = asked)

## Page 22

*[PICTURE: Bright sunshine breaking through clouds over the city of Nineveh, people looking up joyfully, a sense of peace. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

God saw that the people were truly sorry. He forgave them! He did not destroy the city. God was happy that they chose to do what was right.

### TIGRINYA:

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፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡

(Pronunciation: ፡፡፡፡፡ = Haredom = forgave them, ፡፡፡፡ = qinu'e = right, ፡፡፡፡፡ = tehgose = was happy)



[PICTURE: Jonah sitting under a small plant on a hill overlooking Nineveh, looking thoughtful. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jonah sat on a hill watching the city. God taught Jonah an important lesson - that He loves all people everywhere, and wants everyone to come back to Him.

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## Page 24

*[PICTURE: Jonah walking happily along a path with a peaceful smile, birds flying overhead, beautiful landscape. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

### ENGLISH:

Jonah learned that we cannot hide from God. God is everywhere! And God's love is for everyone - even people we think are too bad to be forgiven.

### TIGRINYA:

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ጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ'ጵ - ጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵጵጵጵጵ ጵጵጵ'ጵጵጵ

*(Pronunciation: ጵጵጵጵጵ = kinHibae = to hide, ጵጵጵ = fiqri = love, ጵጵጵጵጵ = niHdiget = forgiveness)*

*[PICTURE: A beautiful ocean scene with a friendly big fish swimming peacefully, a rainbow in the sky, children playing on the shore. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]*

Remember: when God asks you to do something, always obey! God loves you so much and His plans are always the best. Trust God like Jonah learned to do!

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0000000 00000 00 00 00 0000'000 000 000 000000 000000 000!

27/32

**English:** We should always obey God, even when it is hard or scary. God loves everyone and wants us to share His love with others. We cannot hide from God because He is everywhere.

file:///projects/sandbox/children-bible-stories/books/book07\_jonah\_big\_fish.html

## Bible Verse / ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ

**English:** "Those who cling to worthless idols turn away from God's love for them." -  
Jonah 2:8

**Tigrinya:** "ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት" - ቅዱስ 2:8

## Talk About It / ስላሰብን'ኛ ስላሰብን

1. Why did Jonah run away from God? / ስላሰብን ስላሰብንን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?
2. What happened when Jonah was thrown into the sea? / ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?
3. What did Jonah do inside the big fish? / ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?
4. What can we learn from Jonah's story? / ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?

**English:** Dear God, help me to always obey You, even when I feel scared. Thank You for loving me and being patient with me. Help me to share Your love with everyone. Amen.

file:///projects/sandbox/children-bible-stories/books/book07\_jonah\_big\_fish.html

## Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories Series

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1. ስምዐን ስም ስም ስምዐን - Baby Moses in the Basket
2. ስምዐን ስምዐን - David and Goliath
3. ስም ስም ስምዐን - The Good Samaritan
4. ስምዐን ስም - ስም ስም - Noah's Ark
5. ስምዐን ስም ስምዐን ስምዐን - Daniel in the Lions' Den
6. ስምዐን ስም ስም - Joseph's Colorful Coat
7. ስምዐን ስም ስም - **Jonah and the Big Fish** ስም
8. ስም 5,000 ስም ስም - Jesus Feeds 5,000 People
9. ስም ስምዐን ስም - The Lost Sheep
10. ስም ስም ስምዐን ስምዐን - Jesus Calms the Storm
11. ስምዐን ስምዐን ስምዐን - Queen Esther's Courage
12. ስም ስምዐን - Ruth and Naomi
13. ስምዐን - ስምዐን ስም ስም ስም - Creation
14. ስም ስም ስም - The Prodigal Son
15. ስምዐን ስም ስም ስምዐን - Elijah and Fire from Heaven
16. ስምዐን ስም ስም - Zacchaeus the Tax Collector
17. ስምዐን ስምዐን - Abraham and Isaac
18. ስም ስም - The Tower of Babel
19. ስም ስምዐን-ስም ስምዐን ስም - Jesus Heals Blind Bartimaeus
20. ስም ስምዐን ስምዐን ስም - Jesus Heals Ten Lepers